

Thursday, 18 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 28° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 24° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 23° 15°	GLASGOW Light rain 17° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The government is set to apologise to victims of forced adoptions in England, acknowledging the historic practice.

Forced adoptions saw unmarried mothers pressured into giving up their babies, often facing immense emotional distress. The Education Secretary confirmed the apology will be issued on behalf of the state. It's a significant moment for those affected by these past policies.

SOCIAL POLICY · UK
- 2

Driving test wait times won't hit their target until autumn next year, much later than initially hoped.

The Transport Secretary had aimed to reduce the backlog to just seven weeks by this autumn. However, it now looks like learner drivers will be waiting longer than expected. It's frustrating news for those keen to get on the road.

TRANSPORT · UK
- 3

Good news for your wallet: inflation has unexpectedly remained steady, largely thanks to slower food price rises.

The Office for National Statistics reported that higher petrol prices were balanced out by more modest increases in the cost of meat, dairy, and vegetables. This offers a bit of breathing room for household budgets. It's a positive sign amidst ongoing cost-of-living concerns.

ECONOMY · UK
- 4

A former health worker has been charged with trying to sell the Princess of Wales's medical records.

The individual allegedly attempted to access her private information while she was undergoing abdominal surgery. This serious breach of privacy has sparked widespread concern. It raises questions about data security within the health service.

ROYAL · UK
- 5

Tragically, one patient has died and three people were injured after an ambulance and a car collided in Glasgow.

Police were called to the scene on Balmore Road on Tuesday evening, where the serious incident occurred. Investigations are now underway to understand exactly what happened. Our thoughts are with everyone affected.

EMERGENCY SERVICES · UK

What's coming up

- 1 **The new Toy Story 5 is dividing critics, though many are praising its 'cautionary' message about technology.**
Tom Hanks, Tim Allen, and Joan Cusack all return for the fifth instalment of the beloved animated franchise. It seems the film is sparking conversation about its deeper themes. Are you excited to see what Woody and Buzz get up to next?

ON AIR – What are your thoughts on classic films tackling modern issues like technology?
FILM · COMING SOON

- 2 **The Darkness are set to rock the new He-Man theme tune, bringing their signature sound to the classic cartoon!**
The band, originally from Lowestoft, will feature on the soundtrack alongside legendary Queen guitarist Brian May. It sounds like a powerful combination for fans of both music and animation. Get ready for some serious rock anthems!

ON AIR – What classic TV show theme tune would you love to hear a modern band cover?
MUSIC · COMING SOON

- 3 **Filming has begun on a brand new comedy from Ruth Jones and Steve Speirs, described as '35 years in the making'!**
The Gavin & Stacey co-creator says the project has been a long time coming, with both actors busy on other ventures. It promises to be a much-anticipated collaboration from two beloved British talents. We can't wait to see what hilarious situations they've cooked up!

ON AIR – Which two British comedy actors would you love to see team up for a new show?
TV · COMING SOON

- 4 **The Grammy Awards are expanding, adding new categories for Asian Pop and Latin songs!**
This move follows recent wins for artists like Bad Bunny and the increasing global popularity of genres like K-Pop. It's a fantastic step towards recognising a wider range of musical talent. It's great to see the Grammys evolving!

ON AIR – What other music genres do you think deserve their own dedicated award categories?
AWARDS · FUTURE

- 5 **A West End theatre is set to be renamed in honour of the legendary Dame Judi Dench!**
The Shaftesbury Theatre will soon bear her name, celebrating her incredible contribution to the performing arts. It's a wonderful tribute to one of Britain's most cherished actresses. A truly fitting honour for a national treasure!

ON AIR – If you could name a theatre after any living British actor, who would it be and why?
THEATRE · FUTURE

On the schedule

1 **England's World Cup campaign kicks off with Jude Bellingham set to start in the coveted number 10 role against Croatia.**

All eyes will be on Bellingham as he takes on a pivotal position in England's opening match. The team will be hoping for a strong start to their tournament. It's a huge moment for the young star!

ON AIR – Do you think Bellingham is the right choice for England's number 10, or would you pick someone else?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Hull City could face a points deduction in the Premier League if they don't sell players soon.**

After winning the play-off final, Hull must offload players before the end of the month to avoid potential penalties. It's a tricky situation for the newly promoted club. What a way to start your Premier League return!

ON AIR – How much pressure does this put on newly promoted teams to balance finances and squad strength?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 **England stars Immanuel Feyi-Waboso and Alex Mitchell are set for surprise returns for their clubs in Saturday's Prem final.**

Exeter wing Feyi-Waboso and Northampton scrum-half Mitchell are expected to play after being cleared. It's a huge boost for their respective teams ahead of the Twickenham showdown. Who do you think will come out on top?

ON AIR – Which player's return do you think will have the biggest impact on the Premiership final?
RUGBY · UK

4 **British number five Arthur Fery has reached the Queen's quarter-finals with a 'best-ever' win!**

Fery produced a superb display to beat Adrian Mannarino, keeping home hopes alive in the HSBC Championships. It's a fantastic achievement for the young Brit. Could he go all the way?

ON AIR – How exciting is it to see a British player making waves at Queen's, and could this be a sign of future Grand Slam success?
TENNIS · UK

5 **A moment to remember for Sonny Baker as he takes his first Test wicket for England against New Zealand!**

Baker removed Rachin Ravindra for 33, as New Zealand fell to 107-4 on the opening day of the second Test at The Oval. It's a dream start for the young bowler. What a way to make your mark!

ON AIR – How important is it for young players to seize these early opportunities in Test cricket?
CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Research highlights a growing trend for 'digital decluttering' – organising digital files and photos.**
Many people are finding that tidying up their digital lives can reduce stress and improve productivity. It's like spring cleaning for your devices!
- 2 The humble 'picnic blanket' is getting a stylish makeover, with unique designs becoming popular.**
From retro patterns to waterproof wonders, families are investing in special blankets to make their outdoor dining experiences even more memorable.
- 3 A study suggests that 'communal cooking' – preparing meals with neighbours or friends – is boosting community spirit.**
Sharing recipes and kitchen duties is not only fun but also helps reduce food waste and fosters stronger local connections.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'leaf art' is encouraging more people to explore nature creatively.**
Using fallen leaves to create intricate designs and collages is a free, calming activity for all ages, often shared on social media.
- 5 New research indicates that 'mindful walking' in urban parks can significantly improve mood and reduce anxiety.**
Taking time to notice the small details of nature, even in a city setting, offers a quick mental refresh.
- 6 The popularity of 'recycled craft workshops' is soaring, turning everyday items into unique treasures.**
People are enjoying transforming old jars, clothes, and cardboard into new decorative or practical items, promoting sustainability and creativity.
- 7 Experts are noting a rise in 'book-swapping clubs' as a sustainable way to enjoy new reads.**
These friendly groups allow members to exchange books they've finished for something new, fostering a love of reading without the cost or waste.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'rearranging' what in a supermarket, just to make it look neater?

ANSWER: THE TINS OF BAKED BEANS!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a specific 'greeting' or 'farewell' phrase we use with our pets, even if they don't quite understand?

ANSWER: A SPECIAL VOICE FOR 'HELLO' AND 'GOODBYE'!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a new 'local gem' – a little shop, a cafe, or a park – that you wish you'd known about sooner?

What's a fantastic local spot you've recently found that you think everyone should know about? Let us know!

- We all have those 'unwritten rules' in life, don't we? Things that aren't officially rules, but we all just sort of know to do or not do.

What's an unwritten rule that you absolutely swear by, that you think makes life a bit smoother or more polite?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of pugs is called a 'grumble'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Baby puffins are called 'pufflings'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£33 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£33 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A bolt of lightning is six times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The total weight of all ants on Earth is estimated to be greater than the total weight of all humans.
- The inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one.
- Cows have best friends and get stressed when separated from them.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to thermal expansion of the iron.
- Bananas are berries, but strawberries are not.

On this day

Day 169 of the year, 196 days left in 2026. Today Autistic Pride Day (International); Christian feast day: Bernard Mizeki (Anglican and Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Elisabeth of Schönau; Christian feast day: Gregorio Barbarigo. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1987 — Moeen Ali, English cricketer
- 1973 — Ray LaMontagne, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1927 — Paul Eddington, English actor (died 1995)
- 1961 — Alison Moyet, English singer-songwriter
- 1941 — Delia Smith, English chef and author
- 1952 — Isabella Rossellini, Italian actress, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1971 — Nigel Owens, Welsh rugby referee and TV presenter
- 1976 — Blake Shelton, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1983 — Mona Mahmudnizhad, together with nine other women of the Bahá'í Faith, is sentenced to death and hanged in Shiraz, Iran over her religious beliefs.
- 1953 — The Egyptian revolution of 1952 ends with the overthrow of the Muhammad Ali dynasty and the declaration of the Republic of Egypt.
- 1940 — The "Finest Hour" speech is delivered by Winston Churchill.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2018 — An earthquake of magnitude 6.1 strikes northern Osaka.
- 1983 — Space Shuttle program: STS-7, Astronaut Sally Ride becomes the first American woman in space.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1972 — Staines air disaster: One hundred eighteen people are killed when a BEA H.S. Trident crashes minutes after takeoff from London's Heathrow Airport.
- 1948 — Britain, France and the United States announce that on June 21, the Deutsche Mark will be introduced in western Germany and West Berlin. Over the next six days, Communists increasingly restrict access to Berlin.[citation needed]

- 2009 — The Lunar Reconnaissance Orbiter (LRO), a NASA robotic spacecraft is launched.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 170 of the year, 195 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Deodatus (or Didier) of Nevers (or of Jointures); Christian feast day: Gervasius and Protasius (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Hildegim of Châlons; Christian feast day: Juliana Falconieri. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2004 — Millie Gibson, English actress
- 1972 — Robin Tunney, American actress
- 1980 — Jean Carroll, Irish cricketer
- 1970 — Brian Welch, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1975 — Hugh Dancy, English actor and model
- 1992 — Keaton Jennings, South African-English cricketer
- 1998 — Atticus Shaffer, American actor and YouTuber
- 1964 — Brian Vander Ark, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2007 — The al-Khilani Mosque bombing in Baghdad leaves 78 people dead and another 218 injured.
- 2009 — Mass riots involving over 10,000 people and 10,000 police officers break out in Shishou, China, over the dubious circumstances surrounding the death of a local chef.
- 1961 — Kuwait declares independence from the United Kingdom.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1990 — The Communist Party of the Russian Soviet Federative Socialist Republic is founded in Moscow.
- 2007 — The al-Khilani Mosque bombing in Baghdad leaves 78 people dead and another 218 injured.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)